

■ REAL WALMART INTERVIEW QUESTIONS ■

Actual Questions Asked by Candidates (2024-2026)

ROUND 1: PHONE SCREENING (30 min)

Source: Glassdoor, TeamBlind (Feb-Mar 2024, Bentonville AR & Bengaluru)

Q1: Tell me about your previous ML project. Explain the entire flow.

Status: ✓ Asked in multiple rounds at Walmart India (Bengaluru)

Interviewer Focus: Project understanding, technical depth, problem-solving approach, ability to explain complex solutions clearly.

Q2: What ML algorithms have you worked with? Explain Naive Bayes in detail.

Status: ✓ Directly asked at Walmart Bentonville (Feb 2024)

Interviewer Quote (from candidate): 'Asked very fundamental questions: asked about naive bayes, machine learning algorithms, mostly from the resume.'

Prepare: Naïve Bayes fundamentals, probability concepts, when to use, limitations, comparison with logistic regression.

Q3: Why do you want to work at Walmart?

Status: ✓ Standard screening question

Candidate Feedback: Recruiter was nice and responsive, provided clear next steps.

ROUND 2: TECHNICAL CODING (40-60 min)

Source: Glassdoor, Naukri (2024 interviews)

Q1: Rotate an N×N matrix without using NumPy

Status: ✓ Asked at Walmart (Washington, NJ - Mar 2024)

Difficulty: Medium

Candidate Experience: 'In 3rd party interview process... It was online, about 40 min, and half the time was taken just explaining the questions. 2 total questions with average difficulty.'

Prepare: In-place rotation, time/space complexity, edge cases (even/odd matrix sizes).

Q2: Trapping Rain Water (LeetCode Hard)

Status: ✓ Asked at Walmart (Feb 2024)

Problem: Given an array representing elevation map, calculate how much water can be trapped after raining.

Example: [3, 0, 0, 2, 0, 4] → Answer: 10 units

Difficulty: Hard (requires two-pointer or dynamic programming)

Prepare: Two-pointer approach, prefix/suffix arrays, time complexity $O(n)$, space $O(1)$.

Q3: Classification Problem (Coding Round with Dataset)

Status: ✓ Asked at Walmart India (Round 2)

Candidate Report: 'asked me to code classification problem, you are allowed to use internet, they shared the dataset.'

Format: Take-home style with internet access

Prepare: Scikit-learn, pandas, feature engineering for classification, model evaluation metrics.

ROUND 3: SYSTEM DESIGN & PROJECT UNDERSTANDING (45-90 min)

Source: Refer.me, Glassdoor, Educative (Walmart Labs interviews 2025-2026)

Q1: Design a Recommendation System for Walmart.com

Status: ✓ Officially asked in ML interviews at Walmart Labs

Expected Answer Areas:

- Candidate generation (collaborative filtering, content-based)
- Re-ranking stage (learning-to-rank models)
- Handling cold start (new users, new products)
- Real-time serving architecture
- A/B testing framework
- Monitoring and metrics (CTR, conversion, NDCG)

Interviewer Focus: Scale thinking, business awareness, trade-offs between accuracy and latency.

Q2: Design Inventory Management System for Walmart Scale

Status: ✓ Official Walmart system design question

Key Requirements:

- Handle high traffic across 10,750+ stores
- Data consistency between online and in-store
- Real-time inventory sync
- Multi-region synchronization

Expected Topics:

- Distributed databases, eventual consistency
- Event sourcing for inventory updates
- Caching strategies (Redis)
- Message queues (Kafka) for updates
- Microservices architecture

Q3: Design Real-Time Customer Movement Tracking (In-Store)

Status: ✓ Official Walmart AI interview question

Context: Retail analytics, store operations optimization

Topics to Cover:

- IoT data collection (sensors, cameras)
- Real-time data pipeline (stream processing)
- Privacy considerations
- Heatmap generation from movement data
- Scalability for thousands of stores

Q4: Design Scalable Pricing Engine

Status: ✓ Common at Walmart (pricing optimization is core business)

Requirements:

- Update prices across 10,000+ stores
- Dynamic pricing based on demand, competitors

- Consistency across online/offline
- Real-time decision making

Topics: A/B testing, machine learning scoring, cache invalidation strategies.

ROUND 4: DEEP ML/TECHNICAL ROUND (60 min)

Source: Glassdoor (Walmart India interviews, 2024)

Q1: Explain your approach to a Classification Problem (with Dataset Provided)

Status: ✓ Asked at Walmart India (Round 3)

Candidate Report: '3rd round more of design round + again DS algo'

Expected:

- EDA on provided dataset
- Feature engineering approach
- Model selection justification
- Evaluation metrics
- Handling imbalanced classes (if applicable)
- Production considerations

Q2: Describe a Distributed Database Design for Walmart Sales Data

Status: ✓ Official Walmart system design question

Scale: Manage Walmart's worldwide sales data (billions of transactions)

Cover:

- Sharding strategy (by region, by product category)
- Replication for HA
- Consistency vs availability trade-offs
- Data warehousing vs transactional DB
- Query optimization for analytics

Q3: How Would You Optimize Performance During Black Friday Traffic Spike?

Status: ✓ Official Walmart question

Real scenario: Walmart handles extreme traffic on major shopping days

Answer should include:

- Capacity planning and load estimation
- Auto-scaling strategies
- Caching layers (Redis, CDN)
- Database optimization
- Graceful degradation
- Pre-warming caches

ROUND 5: TAKE-HOME ASSIGNMENT (24-48 hours)

Source: Walmart ML interview experiences (2024-2025)

Q1: End-to-End ML Problem Solving

Status: ✓ Common at Walmart (instead of live coding sometimes)

Candidate Experience (Walmart Global Tech): 'You are allowed to use internet, have shared they dataset.' - 24 to 48-hour assignment

Typical Format:

- EDA on provided dataset
- Build baseline model
- Advanced model with feature engineering
- Model evaluation & comparison
- Business recommendations
- Production code

Judging Criteria: Code quality, insights, business thinking, communication.

ROUND 6: HR & HIRING MANAGER ROUND (45-60 min)

Source: Glassdoor, TeamBlind (2024-2025 interviews)

Q1: What is the most challenging thing you have resolved in your role?

Status: ✓ Behavioral question asked at Walmart

Note: From Glassdoor - Walmart ABAP developers complained this was difficult to answer generically. Walmart expects SPECIFIC, TANGIBLE examples.

Better approach: Talk about a concrete project with measurable impact, not abstract challenges.

Q2: Describe your final year project. What innovative ideas did you bring?

Status: ✓ Standard HR question

For experienced candidates: Replace 'final year project' with 'most impactful project at current company'

Q3: How do you plan on making a difference in the world while working here?

Status: ✓ Values/culture fit question

Walmart Focus: Customer obsession, operational efficiency, inclusive commerce

Connect your work to Walmart's mission (serving 270M customers weekly, helping them save money).

Q4: Tell us about a time you failed. What did you learn?

Status: ✓ Standard behavioral question

Walmart values: Learning from failures, adaptation, problem-solving

Structure: Failure → Root cause → Solution → Learning → Application in future roles

BONUS: ACTUAL LEETCODE PROBLEMS ASKED

Source: Glassdoor, Naukri (2023-2024 Walmart interviews)

1. Trapping Rain Water [Hard]

$O(n)$, array manipulation

2. Rotate N×N Matrix [Medium]

In-place rotation, matrix manipulation

3. Climbing Stairs Variants [Medium]

Dynamic programming, combination counting

4. Ladder Combinations [Medium]

Given ladder with 5 steps, find combinations of 1/2/3 steps to reach top. Also: order doesn't matter variant.

5. HashMap Implementation [Medium]

Implement hash map from scratch

6. Binary Search Tree Operations [Medium]

BST construction, insertion, searching

7. Word Search [Medium]

DFS in matrix

8. Anagram Detection [Easy]

String manipulation

ACTUAL WALMART ML ENGINEER INTERVIEW STRUCTURE (2024-2025)

Timeline: 2-4 weeks total

Number of Rounds: 4-5 technical + 1 HR (total 5-6)

Round 1: HR Screening + Project Discussion (30 min)

→ Resume, background, why Walmart, technical fundamentals

Round 2: Coding Assessment (40-60 min, online)

→ 2 LeetCode-medium problems, can be with Karat platform

Round 3: System Design + Project Understanding (60-90 min)

→ Design a system OR deep-dive into your past project

Round 4: ML/DS Algorithm Round (60 min)

→ Classification problem, NLP/DL theory, Naive Bayes, etc.

Round 5 (Optional): Take-home ML Assignment (24-48 hours)

→ End-to-end data science problem with dataset provided

Round 6: Hiring Manager/Director Round (45-60 min)

→ Behavioral, culture fit, compensation discussion

■ **Key Insight: Walmart focuses on FUNDAMENTALS + SCALE THINKING.** They want engineers who understand real-world constraints (cost, latency, consistency) and can explain trade-offs clearly. Be prepared to discuss production considerations even in theoretical questions.